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National Cancer Control Strategy to 2030

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Today, the Minister of Health of Ukraine Zoryana Skaletska presented the draft National Strategy for the Control of Oncological Diseases until 2030. Its main task is to reduce the incidence of cancer in

Ukraine through prevention, early detection, high-quality treatment of cancer patients, improving the quality of life of patients and reducing the mortality rate.

To achieve the set goals, the National Strategy provides for several important areas of the Ministry's work:

Ensure primary prevention of oncological diseases by reducing the impact of risk factors and improving the awareness of the population with involvement in active actions.

Promote early detection of oncological diseases.

To ensure equal and continuous access to a capable network of health care institutions for the diagnosis and treatment of oncological diseases.

Develop a capable network of providing high-quality, coordinated and

affordable oncology treatment in children based on a multidisciplinary approach with the provision of decent care and support for children, cancer patients and their families.

Provide rehabilitation, care and palliative care to cancer patients and support to their caregivers at all levels.

Improve information systems for cancer registration and monitoring of cancer patients to track the dynamics and evaluate the results of cancer control measures.

To improve the level of professional education of doctors, nursing staff and medical workers in order to increase the quantity and quality of human resources.

Promote research with subsequent use of results to control oncological diseases.

Prevention and early detection

of oncological diseases

Prevention of cancer is one of the effective ways to reduce the incidence rate. To do this, it is worth focusing on promoting a healthy lifestyle: giving up bad habits, active recreation. Also, people should constantly receive information about the early symptoms of cancer and be sure to inform the family doctor if there are relevant complaints.

It is also important to reduce/eliminate specific risk factors for cancer. The possibility of introducing immunization against the human papillomavirus at the national level was considered.

The strategy assumes that cost-effective and effective screening for cervical cancer and colorectal cancer will be implemented.

Rehabilitation, care, palliative

care

The objectives of this part of the strategy are based on the provision of palliative care at all levels of health care.

It is also necessary to ensure the availability of drugs to treat pain and other symptoms at all levels.

It is necessary to develop and implement programs to support people who have survived cancer together with civil society. To coordinate these processes and provide quality assistance, a network will be established between governmental and non-governmental organizations.

Treatment of oncological diseases in children

In Ukraine, about 1,000 children are diagnosed with cancer every year. At

the same time, there is no increase in child morbidity either in Ukraine or around the world.

The strategy will be aimed primarily at reorganizing the service delivery process to improve the quality of treatment. This process will include both the restructuring of the system and the creation of new links that will help improve the quality of care for children with cancer.

Creation of several Centers of Excellence.

Pediatric palliative care.

Integrated outpatient pediatric hematology/oncology.

Launch of non-family transplants of hematopoietic stem cells to children on the basis of the Okhmatdit VATL, the beginning of autologous GSC transplants for children in the regions of Ukraine.

The draft Strategy states that qualified training of

doctors and junior medical staff should take place. This is, in particular, structured training of pediatric hematologists-oncologists and nurses using international recommendations

The main goal of this task is to ensure the quality of life of patients and their families.

Treatment of adults

In 2018, about 170 thousand new cases of cancer and 98 thousand deaths from cancer were registered in Ukraine. The draft Strategy identifies the need to ensure continuous and equal access to a capable network of health care facilities for the diagnosis and treatment of oncological diseases in adults.

Provide equal access to the main modern methods of radiological, endoscopic, pathomorphological diagnostics.

Create patient routes
for comprehensive
cancer treatment
across the country.

Ensure the availability
of basic and auxiliary
therapeutic drugs
(chemotherapy,
hormonal and biological
therapy).

Improve the quality of
treatment in specialized
centers by developing
and supporting a
multidisciplinary team
approach to patient
management with the
involvement of
surgeons, radiation
therapists, clinical
oncologists, pediatric
oncologists,
pathologists and other
medical specialists

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